> Jinnah was as anti-British as any Congressman. The British hated him. Willingdon recommended to his successor as Governor of Bombay, Lord Lloyd, Jinnah's deportation to Burma. Lloyd 'was not disposed to begin his career by conferring unnecessary martyrdom'. [6]

Indeed, it is said that 'two of his best performances stand out', and of these, '[o]ne was his attack on the order banning Vallabhbhai Patel from speaking for one month at a public meeting', [7] while '[t]he other instance was his powerful defence of Bhagat Singh in the Assembly'. [8] Needless to say, so maligned is Jinnah in India today that neither events would be remotely accredited to him by the Government of India, which is why as Noorani states, 'as a person Jinnah has received less than is his due'. [9] While it is true that in his monumental 'Jinnah', [10] the political scientist Dr Ishtiaq Ahmed has meticulously traced Jinnah's journey from Indian nationalist to Muslim communitarian, it is worth recalling the time when he stood for communal peace and harmony. One only has to note how when he gave evidence before the British Parliament Joint Select Committee on the Government of India Bill Secretary of State Edwin S. Montagu 'began to question him in an offensive manner'. When he was quizzed whether 'at the earliest moment you wish to do away in political life with any distinction between Mohammedans and Hindoos', he replied: 'Yes. Nothing will please me more than when that day comes.' [11] Noorani has no doubt that 'Jinnah set an example equalled by few' [12] and that 'the final responsibility for partition was not his'. [13] This is because 'a united India implied a sharing of power, which the Congress abhorred. Worse still, it had no role for Jinnah as a partner in a united India. He had "no real place in the country" Nehru maintained repeatedly'. It is for this reason that 'Jinnah was an expellee, not an exile. His dreams lie buried in India as well as in Pakistan'. [14]

It was therefore in no small measure thanks to Jinnah's defence of Bhagat Singh and his castigation of the ill-fated and ill-thought-out government measures that the Hunger Strike Bill failed to pass. The assembly rejected it lock, stock and barrel. The government, however, was determined to press ahead. It was going to have Bhagat Singh convicted and sentenced to death one way or the other, by hook or crook. If legislative action would not